Employee Handbook: HR & Work Rules

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Purpose & Scope

This policy defines baseline workplace expectations for employees and contractors of Northstar Systems, a fictional software company. It is a synthetic document created for testing document ingestion, retrieval, and source citations in the Company Intelligence AI project.

Working Hours and Availability

- **Core collaboration hours:** 10:00–16:00 India Standard Time (IST), Monday through Friday.
- **Standard schedule:** Teams agree on working hours with their manager. Employees should keep their calendar accurate and mark planned absences.
- **Remote work:** Use approved company devices and secure network access. Do not leave confidential material visible in public spaces.
- **Attendance:** If an unexpected absence affects a deliverable or customer commitment, notify your manager and immediate collaborators as soon as practical.

Leave and Time Off

- **Planned leave:** Submit a request in the HR portal at least five working days in advance when possible.
- **Urgent leave:** Notify your manager before the start of your workday, or as soon as reasonably possible.
- **Approval:** Leave is approved by the employee's manager, subject to team coverage and applicable law.

Communication and Meetings

- Use the team project tracker for commitments, owners, due dates, and status updates.
- Share meeting agendas for recurring decision meetings at least one working day beforehand when practical.
- Record decisions and action items in the relevant project workspace within one working day.

Information Security and Confidentiality

- Use multi-factor authentication wherever it is available and never share passwords or one-time codes.
- Store company files only in approved company-managed services. Do not forward confidential files to personal email.
- Classify information as Public, Internal, Confidential, or Restricted before sharing it outside the immediate team.
- Report suspected data exposure, lost devices, or suspicious login activity to Security Operations immediately.

Equipment and Expenses

- Company equipment is intended primarily for approved work. Keep operating systems and security tools updated.
- Submit expense claims with itemized receipts within 30 calendar days of the transaction.
- Expenses above ■10,000 require written manager approval before purchase, except documented emergencies.

Performance and Feedback

- Managers should hold a one-to-one conversation with each direct report at least once every two weeks.
- Project feedback should be specific, respectful, and tied to observable outcomes.
- Formal performance reviews occur twice per year; individual teams may conduct additional planning reviews.

Where to Ask for Help

Topic	Contact / Channel	Target response
HR and leave questions	People Operations queue	2 working days
Security incident	Security Operations on-call	Immediately
Workplace equipment	IT Helpdesk portal	1 working day

This sample policy is fictional and is not legal or employment advice. If two policies conflict, consult People Operations for the current approved policy.